

Bobby Flennoy

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UX RESEARCHER & DEVELOPER | CS + COGNITIVE NEUROSCIENCE @ UTA

My Cognitive Neuroscience background means I understand the **why** behind attention, cognitive load, and behavioral patterns, and I apply that directly to product decisions. I work across discovery interviews, heuristic audits, MaxDiff surveys, and Python-based data synthesis, and I **build** the products I research.

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Arlington

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Cognitive Neuroscience / Expected Aug. 2026

SKILLS

- **Research Methods:** Moderated Interviews, Usability Testing, Heuristic Evaluation, Card Sorting, MaxDiff Analysis, Discovery Research, Contextual Inquiry, Affinity Mapping, Information Architecture
- **Data & Analytics:** SQL, Python (Pandas, NLTK/VADER), Qualtrics, Alchemer, Maze, Optimal Workshop
- **Design & Research:** Figma, FigJam, Miro, React, Next.js, Git, Dovetail, Airtable, Notion, Zoom, Teams

EXPERIENCE

Quantitative UX Research Intern

CBRE / Jun. 2025 – Aug. 2025

- **MaxDiff Survey:** Designed a **MaxDiff** survey from scratch using **Alchemer**, reading academic papers to ensure validity at our sample size, to rank feature importance for an internal enterprise facility management platform. Recruited **500+** facility managers/coordinators, drafted recruitment emails, and presented findings to the **Director of Product** and **VP of Digital & Technology**, informing the Q3/Q4 engineering roadmap.
- **Heuristic Evaluation:** Audited the platform against **Nielsen's 10 heuristics**, surfacing **40+ issues** across 11 tags. Built an **Airtable** tracking template so the team could run future evaluations without starting from scratch, then collaborated with design to triage each finding as addressed, in progress, or unknown.
- **Data Synthesis:** Used **Python (Pandas + VADER sentiment analysis)** to cross-reference HE findings against months of historical open-ended survey responses, confirming that search & filtering and information-dense table views were the platform's most consistently reported pain points, making the usability pillars credible to stakeholders rather than just my opinion.

Product Researcher & Developer

Pearl Discovery (Non-Profit) / Mar. 2026 – Present

- **Discovery Research:** Conducted **7** interviews with teachers, coaches, and parents to understand how they actually learn about new students. Core finding: behavioral understanding rarely follows a process, it almost always surfaces during peer collaboration. That finding directly shaped the roadmap, leading to a feature analyzing how students' behavioral profiles interact in group settings. Used insights to design/build dashboard.

HCI Researcher

Hybrid Atelier Lab (UT Arlington) / May 2024 – Aug. 2024

- **Research & Validation:** Ran **card sorting** exercises with **5 digital fabrication experts** using physical printed cards, a deliberate choice since hands-first people in a fab lab prefer physical objects > screens. Built the resulting **taxonomy** into an AI assistant with domain-specific laser-cutting knowledge and tested it against a generic LLM using a **Likert** trust survey. Preliminary results showed higher trust ratings for the domain-specific system, pointing to contextual grounding mattering more than raw model capability for specialist users.

PROJECTS

TeachTrack: Departmental SLO Analytics Platform

- **Discovery:** Interviewed two faculty stakeholders and found the existing evaluation system captures student sentiment but gives professors nothing actionable. Also found no syllabus coverage verification (a professor had already skipped an entire unit undetected) Added verification to the survey framework based on that finding.
- **Outcome:** Designed, prototyped, and built the full platform with iterative usability testing. Pitched to the **CS Department Chair**. Under review for **Fall 2026 implementation**.

EXTRACURRICULARS

- **President & Student Advisor:** Association for Computing Machinery (ACM) | Aug. 2023 – Present
- **Creative Director:** HackUTA | **600+ attendees** Dec. 2022 – Dec. 2025
- **Speaker & Mentor:** WeHacks | Design Thinking Workshop | Apr. 2024
- **1st Place:** HackUTD (Infrastructure & Compute Challenge) | Nov. 2025